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Financing of the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus

Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 and proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 of the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus

Report of the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions

Appropriation for 2024/25	\$56,436,100
Allotment for 2024/25	\$55,294,100
Expenditure for 2024/25	\$55,269,000
Unencumbered balance for 2024/25	\$1,167,100
Appropriation for 2025/26 ^a	\$57,319,100
Projected expenditure for 2025/26 ^{b,c}	\$52,675,900
Projected underexpenditure for 2025/26 ^b	\$4,643,100
Proposal submitted by the Secretary-General for 2026/27 ^d	\$56,279,700
Adjustment recommended by the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	(\$451,600)
Recommendation of the Advisory Committee for 2026/27	\$55,828,100

^a Includes \$26,365,367 in voluntary contributions received from the Government of Cyprus (\$19,865,367) and from the Government of Greece (\$6,500,000).

^b Estimates as at 28 February 2026.

^c Excludes one-time resource requirements to provide for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

^d Includes \$24,383,833 in voluntary contributions received from the Government of Cyprus (\$17,883,833) and from the Government of Greece (\$6,500,000) (A/80/607, para. 68 (e)).



I. Introduction

1. During its consideration of the advance version of the report of the Secretary-General on the financing of the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus (UNFICYP) (A/80/607), the Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions met with representatives of the Secretary-General, who provided additional information and clarification, concluding with written responses received on 6 March 2026. The comments and recommendations of the Advisory Committee on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations are contained in its report (A/80/604), while those pertaining to the findings and recommendations of the Board of Auditors on the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 can be found in its related report (A/80/633).

II. Budget performance for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025

2. By its resolution 78/300, the General Assembly appropriated an amount of \$56,436,100 gross (\$53,872,700 net) for the maintenance of the Force for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025. The allotment issued to the Force amounted to \$55,294,100 (or 98 per cent of the appropriation). Expenditure for the period totalled \$55,269,000 gross (\$52,539,800 net), reflecting a budget implementation rate of 97.9 per cent, with higher-than-budgeted expenditure under civilian personnel (\$560,700, or 3.4 per cent) and reduced requirements under military and police personnel (\$603,400, or 2.4 per cent) and under operational costs (\$1,124,400, or 7.7 per cent).

3. The Advisory Committee was informed that redeployments in the amount of \$560,700 to group II (civilian personnel) from group I (military and police personnel) and group III (operational costs) resulted from expenditure in excess of the appropriation in group II due primarily to the higher actual separation costs for retiring international staff and application of the revised salary scale for national staff. **The Advisory Committee trusts that more detailed information on redeployments will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, in particular on activities curtailed and other lower-than-budgeted expenditure that allowed for resources to be redeployed and the criteria used by UNFICYP to reprioritize resources.**

4. The Advisory Committee notes from information provided to it that unliquidated obligations amounted to \$3,200,000 (or 5.7 per cent of the total appropriation) as at 30 June 2025 for the 2024/25 period, representing an increase of \$174,000 (or 5.8 per cent) compared with the amount of \$3,026,000 as at 30 June 2024 for the 2023/24 period. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, unliquidated obligations had decreased to \$664,600 for the 2024/25 period, comprising \$655,900 under military and police personnel and \$8,700 under operational costs.

5. The unencumbered balance, in gross terms, amounts to \$1,167,100, or 2.1 per cent of the overall level of resources approved for the financial period. A detailed analysis of variances is provided in section III of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/607). As indicated in section II.F of the report, other revenue and adjustments for the 2024/25 period amounted to \$1,429,000, comprising: (a) investment revenue (\$619,600); (b) other/miscellaneous revenue (\$575,400); and (c) the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$234,000).

6. The Advisory Committee notes that it is indicated in paragraphs 43 and 68 of the report of the Secretary-General that credits comprising the unencumbered

balances (\$1,167,100) and other revenue (\$1,429,000) are proposed to be placed into a reserve in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates (see para. 55 below).

Matters pertaining to the report of the Board of Auditors

7. The Advisory Committee also had before it the report of the Board of Auditors on the accounts of the United Nations peacekeeping operations for the financial period ended 30 June 2025 ([A/80/5 \(Vol. II\)](#)). As regards UNFICYP, the Board reviewed, inter alia, the impact of the liquidity constraints on mandate delivery, fuel management, reimbursement to troop-contributing countries and voluntary contributions (*ibid.*, paras. 90, 123 and 267). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the recommendations of the Board of Auditors will be implemented in a timely manner.**

III. Information on performance for the current period

8. With respect to current and projected expenditure for the period from 1 July 2025 to 30 June 2026, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 28 February 2026, expenditure amounted to \$32,190,300. At the end of the current financial period, estimated total expenditure would amount to \$52,675,900, resulting in a projected unencumbered balance of \$4,643,200,¹ or 8.1 per cent, against the approved resources of \$57,319,100.² The Committee notes that the contingency plan reduction has been applied to the assessed portion of the UNFICYP budget, which amounts to \$30,953,733, and not to the total budget of the Force, which also includes voluntary contributions from the Government of Greece and the Government of Cyprus (see also [A/80/643](#), table 10, footnote).

9. The Advisory Committee was informed that, in April 2025, UNFICYP implemented austerity measures to address the liquidity situation, including the suspension of non-essential procurement and travel, the prioritization of payroll, life-support services and other critical expenditure, the postponement of personnel onboarding and projects and the reprioritization of resources towards mandate-critical activities. In that context, UNFICYP has been able to preserve operational continuity and maintain core mandate implementation, notwithstanding financial constraints. However, the operations of UNFICYP continued to be affected significantly by the implementation of the contingency plan, and the Force has repatriated 60 military contingent personnel, 4 military staff officers and 5 United Nations police officers and has kept vacant posts unfilled in line with the hiring freeze. The liquidity challenges have also constrained the Force's operational capacity, resulting in extended patrols across larger areas and a stringent prioritization of tasks, concentrating limited resources on the most sensitive locations while accepting greater risk elsewhere. The Committee was informed that the implementation of the contingency plan has not resulted in a repatriation of contingent-owned equipment during the 2025/26 period. **The Advisory Committee notes that, while UNFICYP has been able to preserve operational continuity and maintain core mandate implementation, liquidity challenges constrained the operational capacity of the Force. The Committee notes that the operational flexibility of UNFICYP has been reduced, affecting the full implementation of the Force's mandate. In that regard, the Committee trusts that all efforts will be undertaken to ensure the security and safety of personnel. The Committee also trusts that an update and a more detailed assessment on the impact of the contingency plan on the implementation of the mandate of the mission will**

¹ Excludes one-time requirements for termination entitlements payable to staff members.

² Includes \$26,365,367 in voluntary contributions received from the Government of Cyprus (\$19,865,367) and from the Government of Greece (\$6,500,000) (see also General Assembly resolution [79/303](#), para. 13).

be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the report and in the next performance report.

10. The Advisory Committee was also informed that, as at 2 February 2026, a total of \$880,498,700 had been assessed on Member States in respect of UNFICYP since its inception. Payments received as at the same date amounted to \$854,171,400, leaving an outstanding balance of \$26,327,300. As at 23 February 2026, the cash available to the Force amounted to \$15,578,537, which was sufficient to cover the three-month operating reserve of \$10,815,500 (excluding reimbursements to troop- and police-contributing countries).

11. The Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 December 2025, the outstanding balance for contingent-owned equipment amounted to \$886,300. The Committee was also informed that, as at 28 February 2026, one death and disability claim was pending. **The Advisory Committee trusts that the outstanding liabilities and claims will be settled in a timely manner.**

IV. Proposed budget for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

A. Mandate and planning assumptions

12. UNFICYP was established by the Security Council in its resolution [186 \(1964\)](#), and its mandate was extended most recently, until 31 January 2027, pursuant to resolution [2815 \(2026\)](#). The planning assumptions and mission support initiatives for the 2026/27 period are summarized in section I.C of the report of the Secretary-General ([A/80/607](#)).

Impact of the UN80 Initiative and culture of efficiency

13. Information on efficiency gains is provided in section II.C of the report of the Secretary-General. The cost estimates for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 take into account efficiency initiatives under military contingent personnel, civilian personnel, facilities and infrastructure and ground transportation in the amount of \$2,468,600. Estimated efficiencies for 2026/27 represent a 4.3 per cent reduction compared with the approved budget for 2025/26, in the context of an overall 1.8 per cent proposed reduction (see para. 16 below). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the proposed budget for the 2026/27 period for UNFICYP was undertaken keeping in mind the spirit of the UN80 Initiative by emphasizing efficiency, cost containment and alignment in accordance with the guidance provided by the Secretariat. The Committee was informed that that efficiencies were identified and cost-reduction measures were implemented, including the proposed abolishment of 11 civilian posts and the reduction of 60 military contingent personnel, 4 military staff officers and 5 United Nations police officers (see also paras. 18–19 below). Efficiency gains were also achieved under operational costs through the increased use of renewable energy and the replacement of obsolete air-conditioning units.

14. **The Advisory Committee notes that the proposed reductions are a result of ongoing liquidity constraints and temporary expenditure compression and a reflection of the mission's structural efficiency gains resulting from process improvements. The Committee trusts that further information on the connection between the proposed reductions and the changes in expected accomplishments and outputs proposed for UNFICYP for 2026/27 will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, to allow for a better assessment of the sustainability and long-term implications of such measures on the implementation of the mandate of the mission.** The Advisory

Committee will further discuss efficiency measures in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

15. The Advisory Committee notes that the proposed budget for UNFICYP projects a 1.8 per cent reduction compared with the approved budget for 2025/26, representing the lowest adjustment among all peacekeeping missions that had no change in mandate. While noting that the Secretary-General did not establish specific reduction targets for the proposed budgets for peacekeeping missions, the Committee considers that the spirit and goals of the UN80 Initiative would be expected to translate into more substantial efficiencies. Given that UNFICYP is a long-standing mission and operates in a stable environment, the Committee is of the view that the modest reduction that has been proposed warrants a clear and detailed justification, which the Committee trusts will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report. The Committee also trusts that additional efforts in that regard will be presented in the next budget submission.

B. Resource requirements

Financial resources

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
						Amount	Percentage
Military and police personnel	25 161.2	24 557.8	25 460.9	13 956.4	23 502.9	(1 958.0)	(7.7)
Civilian personnel	16 615.1	17 175.8	16 926.0	12 027.8	17 036.7	110.7	0.7
Operational costs	14 659.8	13 535.4	14 932.2	6 206.1	15 740.1	807.9	5.4
Gross requirements	56 436.1	55 269.0	57 319.1	32 190.3	56 279.7	(1 039.4)	(1.8)

Note: Detailed information on the financial resources proposed and an analysis of variances are provided in sections II and III of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/607).

16. The proposed requirements for 2026/27 amount to \$56,279,700 and reflect a decrease of \$1,039,400, or 1.8 per cent, compared with the appropriation of \$57,319,100 for the 2025/26 period. The proposed requirements for 2026/27 comprise: (a) an amount of \$31,895,867, or 56.7 per cent; and (b) an amount of \$24,383,833, or 43.3 per cent of the appropriation, funded from voluntary contributions, from the Government of Cyprus (\$17,883,833) and from the Government of Greece (\$6,500,000) (see also A/80/607, para. 68 (e)). Under the provisions of the status-of-forces agreement, the estimated value of the non-budgeted in-kind voluntary contributions by the Government of Cyprus for the 2026/27 period amounts to \$913,800.³

17. The Advisory Committee acknowledges the continued voluntary contributions to UNFICYP from the Government of Cyprus and from the Government of Greece. Detailed information on the financial resources and an analysis of variances is provided in sections II and III of the report of the Secretary-General.

³ The estimated amount of \$913,800 comprises the market value of the costs of United Nations observation posts, offices and accommodation facilities provided by the Government of Cyprus to UNFICYP at no cost for military contingents and United Nations police units, including the UNFICYP headquarters complex.

1. Military and police personnel

<i>Category</i>	<i>Authorized 2024/25^a</i>	<i>Actual as at 30 June 2025</i>	<i>Authorized 2025/26^a</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Authorized and proposed 2026/27</i>	<i>Variance</i>
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)
Military contingents	860	811	860	751	860	—
United Nations police	69	68	69	61	69	—

^a Represents the highest level of authorized strength.

Delayed deployment factors

(Percentage of approved strength)

<i>Category</i>	<i>Budgeted 2024/25</i>	<i>Actual 2024/25</i>	<i>Budgeted 2025/26</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Actual average as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Projected 2026/27</i>
Military contingents	6.2	1.4	5.7	12.7	11.5	13.1
Formed police units	2.9	1.4	1.4	11.6	11.6	8.7

18. The proposed resources for military and police personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$23,502,900, reflecting a decrease of \$1,958,000, or 7.7 per cent, compared with the apportionment of \$25,460,900 for 2025/26. The reduced requirements are attributable primarily to the lower standard troop cost reimbursement and mission subsistence allowance due to the application of the higher vacancy rate of 13.1 per cent compared with 5.7 per cent applied in the approved budget (A/80/607, para. 50).

19. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that adjustments to the composition and number of uniformed personnel at UNFICYP had been guided primarily by the most recent comprehensive strategic review, which was conducted in 2017, pursuant to paragraph 12 of Security Council resolution 2369 (2017). Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that planning assumptions for 2026/27 budget included resources for the possible return of 30 of the 60 military contingent personnel who had been repatriated.

20. **The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for military and police personnel.**

2. Civilian personnel

<i>Category</i>	<i>Approved 2024/25</i>	<i>Encumbered as at 30 June 2025</i>	<i>Approved 2025/26</i>	<i>Actual as at 28 February 2026</i>	<i>Proposed 2026/27</i>	<i>Variance</i>
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	(6)=(5)-(3)
Posts						
International staff	39	36	39	31	37	(2)
National Professional Officers	7	6	7	6	7	—
National General Service staff	115	107	115	91	105	(10)
Temporary positions^a						
International staff	2	1	2	2	2	—
Total	163	150	163	130	151	(12)

^a Funded under general temporary assistance.

21. The proposed resources for civilian personnel for the 2026/27 period amount to \$17,036,700, reflecting an increase of \$110,700, or 0.7 per cent, compared with the approved resources of \$16,926,000 for 2025/26, and are the net result of higher salary and exchange rates, higher vacancy rates for international staff, the proposed abolishment of 2 Field Service and 10 national General Service posts, the proposed establishment of one P-5 post of Chief of Operations and Resource Management and the related abolishment of one P-4 post of Chief of Unit Service Delivery.

Civilian staffing review

22. UNFICYP and the Department of Operational Support conducted a civilian staffing review in the 2024/25 period pursuant to General Assembly resolution [76/274](#). The Secretary-General indicates that the review presented suggestions for dedicated resources for environmental management, the augmentation of air operations with flight follower roles, integrated approaches to data analytics and workforce upskilling in line with the United Nations staff selection 2.0 initiative, which UNFICYP intends to address within existing resources. The review also presented recommendations that UNFICYP continue to explore the possibility of transferring location-independent, transactional functions to shared services and of regularizing the existing two-pillar mission support structure (*ibid.*, paras. 26–28). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the civilian staffing review was not initiated as a UN80 Initiative exercise, but rather that UNFICYP considered that the outcomes were effectively incorporated into contingency planning and the budget formulation for 2026/27. **The Advisory Committee notes the proposed net reduction of 12 civilian staff for the 2026/27 period, including the proposed abolishment of four posts related to the transfer of location-independent services to the Regional Service Centre in Entebbe, Uganda, and the Department of Operational Support. The Committee is of the view that greater efforts should have been made to identify efficiencies, including by repurposing vacant posts or reclassifying vacant posts to lower levels, as operationally feasible. The Committee expects that the next budget submission will include staffing proposals to that effect (see also para. 15 above).**

Recommendations on posts and positions

23. The Secretary-General proposes 151 civilian posts and positions for 2026/27, comprising 39 international staff, including 2 international positions funded through general temporary assistance, and 112 national staff (7 National Professional Officers and 105 national General Service staff), reflecting a net decrease of 12 posts compared with the approved budget for 2025/26.

Structural changes

24. As indicated in paragraphs 32 and 33 of the report of the Secretary-General, following the recommendation of the civilian staffing review, it is proposed that the current two-pillar structure be formalized as follows:

(a) Operations and Resource Management pillar, which will incorporate the Procurement Section;

(b) Supply Chain Management and Service Delivery pillar, ensuring that organizational units managing funds in service delivery are separate from the units performing procurement functions.

25. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the Force's two-pillar configuration aligned with emerging good practice for smaller missions, balancing organizational efficiency with the need to maintain adequate oversight, accountability

and mission-specific support capacity and through guidance from the Department of Operational Support. **The Advisory Committee stresses the importance of preserving the segregation of duties and of adequate risk monitoring to ensure that the streamlined structure does not undermine internal controls and operational capacities. The Committee looks forward to an assessment of the performance of and challenges experienced by the missions with regard to the implementation of their two-pillar support structures in the next report on the overview of peacekeeping operations.**

Establishment

26. In connection with the aforementioned new two-pillar structure, it is proposed that one post of Chief of Operations and Resource Management (P-5) be established. The establishment of this post would be offset by the abolishment of the post of Chief of Service Delivery (P-4) (see below) and is considered an essentially cost-neutral action, as indicated in the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/607, para. 33).

27. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the post of Chief of Operations and Resource Management was considered necessary to provide dedicated senior-level oversight of the integrated operational and resource functions and to provide unified leadership and strategic direction. The proposed establishment would align the structure of UNFICYP with the structures of the United Nations Mission for the Referendum in Western Sahara, the United Nations Disengagement Observer Force and the United Nations Mission in Kosovo, which are of comparable sizes and each of which has a Chief of Operations and Resource Management at the P-5 level reporting to a Chief of Mission Support at the D-1 level.

Abolishment

28. In connection with the new two-pillar structure, it is proposed that the post of Chief of Service Delivery (P-4) be abolished to offset the proposed establishment of the aforementioned post of Chief of Operations and Resource Management (P-5) (A/80/607, para. 33).

29. It is also proposed that two international Field Service posts (one in the Operations and Resource Management pillar and one in the Civil Affairs Section) and six national General Service posts (one long-vacant post in the Office of the Force Commander, one in the Public Information Section, one in the Civil Affairs Section and three in the Operations and Resource Management pillar) be abolished, with the related functions to be absorbed by the remaining posts and positions, allowing UNFICYP to operate with a leaner structure while preserving essential capacities to sustain operational effectiveness.

30. It is proposed that three national General Service posts from the Operations and Resource Management pillar be abolished, which performed location-independent transactional functions, and that one national General Service post that was embedded in the Kuwait Joint Support Office, which provided services for the processing of payroll for UNFICYP national staff and military staff officers. These functions will be transferred to the Regional Service Centre following the planned closure of the Joint Support Office on 30 June 2026.

Continuation of general temporary assistance positions

31. It is proposed that the Programme Management Officer/Mine Action Adviser (P-4) position funded under general temporary assistance be retained, which was established on 1 July 2022 to direct the implementation of the mine action programme of UNFICYP (ibid., para. 36 (a)).

32. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that demining was 1 of the 10 agreed trust-building initiatives intended to advance the political process and that UNFICYP required technical mine action capacity to support the dialogue between the two sides. The Committee was also informed that a political agreement had been reached by the parties in March 2025, reaffirmed in July 2025, which was aimed at allowing the resumption of demining activities. Discussions on the technical aspects are ongoing. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the status of the demining activities, as well as the related work and involvement of the Programme Management Officer/Mine Action Adviser in that process, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

33. It is proposed that the Air Operations Officer (Field Service) position funded under general temporary assistance be retained, within the Aviation Unit, for monitoring, reporting and tracking all aviation activities and being responsible for risk management and quality control of air operations (*ibid.*, para. 36 (b)).

34. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that the civilian staffing review reaffirmed that the position of Air Operations Officer (Field Service) was considered a core and continuous function required under the United Nations aviation standards and was responsible for daily air operations management and aviation operational risk oversight. The review also concluded that the position of Air Operations Officer met the criteria for conversion to an established post but that, because of liquidity constraints, such a conversion would have to have been offset by the abolishment of an equivalent UNFICYP post in the proposed budget for 2026/27. The Committee was informed that UNFICYP would consider proposing the regularization of the Air Operations Officer position to a post when the financial situation of the Organization permits. **The Advisory Committee notes that the position of Air Operations Officer (Field Service) is a continuous function that is required under the United Nations aviation standards and trusts that a proposal for its conversion to a regular post will be kept under review.**

Nationalization

35. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that UNFICYP had pursued nationalization opportunities where operationally viable and that those efforts had resulted in the nationalization of 75 per cent of civilian personnel. Additional nationalization opportunities would be assessed on a case-by-case basis, in consideration of the requirement to retain international oversight for core coordination, compliance and cross-pillar functions and of the operating environment across remote sectors. The Committee was informed that the ratio of national staff to international staff was expected to decrease from 2.98 in 2025/26 to 2.87 in 2026/27.

Vacant posts

36. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, there were 24 vacant posts (1 D-1, 1 P-5, 2 P-4, 1 P-3, 2 Field Service, 16 national General Service and 1 National Professional Officer). One National Professional Officer post in the Civil Affairs Section has been vacant for more than 24 months and onboarding of the candidate has been deferred owing to the implementation of the contingency plan due to liquidity constraints. **The Advisory Committee trusts that an update on the number of vacant posts and their recruitment status will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission. The Committee trusts that remaining long-vacant posts continue to be critically reviewed in the context of the next budget submission.** The Committee discusses

vacant and long-vacant posts in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

37. The Advisory Committee was also informed that there were 10 posts as at 31 December 2025 encumbered by staff with approved separation requests as part of the early separation programme. **The Advisory Committee trusts that detailed and updated information on staff approved for the early separation programme, as well as on the related costs, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report and in the next budget submission.**

Vacancy rates

Vacancy rates^a

(Percentage)

Category	Budgeted 2024/25	Actual 2024/25	Budgeted 2025/26	Actual as at 31 December 2025	Actual average, January– December 2025	Actual as at 28 February 2026	Actual average, July 2025– February 2026	Proposed 2026/27
Civilian personnel								
International staff	5.1	7.7	5.1	17.9	10.3	20.5	15.4	13.5
National staff								
National Professional Officers	14.3	14.3	14.3	14.3	14.3	14.3	14.3	14.3
National General Service staff	4.3	6.1	6.1	12.2	7.8	20.9	11.3	3.8
Temporary positions								
International staff	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	0.0

^a See also A/80/607, para. 45.

38. The Advisory Committee notes that the vacancy rates proposed for 2026/27 for all staff categories align, in general, with the actual vacancy rates as at 28 February 2026 and the average vacancy rates experienced during the period from January to December 2025, and reflect liquidity constraints and the vacant posts as a result of the aforementioned voluntary early separation of 10 staff members (1 D-1, 1 P-4 and 8 national General Service). **The Advisory Committee trusts that the Secretary-General will provide updated information on the most recent actual and actual average vacancy rates to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report, along with a clear justification where the proposed rates differ from the actual rates, including information on how the rates relate to the impact of proposed abolishments, realistic projected recruitment and potential upcoming vacancies, to the extent possible.**

39. The Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for civilian personnel.

3. Operational costs

(Thousands of United States dollars)

Category	Apportionment (2024/25)	Expenditure (2024/25)	Apportionment (2025/26)	Expenditure as at 28 February 2026	Cost estimates (2026/27)	Variance	
	(1)	(2)	(3)	(4)	(5)	Amount (6)=(5)-(3)	Percentage (7)=(6)÷(3)
Operational costs							
Civilian electoral observers	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Consultants and consulting services	24.8	11.9	31.1	1.5	31.0	(0.1)	(0.3)
Official travel	232.3	138.9	238.4	69.1	238.5	0.1	0.0
Facilities and infrastructure	7 319.4	6 829.1	7 336.9	3 527.8	8 430.7	1 093.8	14.9
Ground transportation	1 894.3	1 833.7	2 096.8	840.2	2 002.0	(94.8)	(4.5)
Air operations	2 534.9	2 274.0	2 489.8	655.1	2 514.1	24.3	1.0
Marine operations	2.8	3.3	2.8	—	—	(2.8)	(100.0)
Communications and information technology	1 591.9	1 647.4	1 638.1	651.2	1 445.9	(192.2)	(11.7)
Medical	296.5	247.5	258.6	184.8	287.7	29.1	11.3
Special equipment	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Other supplies, services and equipment	762.9	549.1	839.7	276.4	790.2	(49.5)	(5.9)
Quick-impact projects	—	—	—	—	—	—	—
Total	14 659.8	13 535.4	14 932.2	6 206.1	15 740.1	807.9	5.4

40. The proposed resources for operational costs for 2026/27 amount to \$15,740,100, reflecting an increase of \$807,900, or 5.4 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$14,932,200 for 2025/26 (A/80/607, sects. II and III). **The Advisory Committee notes that operational costs (group III) are proposed to increase by 5.4 per cent, while the costs for military and police personnel (group I) would be reduced by 7.7 per cent. While cognizant of the impact of exchange rates on the budgeting assumptions for operational costs, the Committee trusts that further justification for the proposed increase, as well as information on all efforts undertaken by UNFICYP to contain the increase in requirements in the context of a reduced footprint and operations, will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

Consultants and consulting services

41. The proposed resources for consultants and consulting services amount to \$31,000 for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$100, or 0.1 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$31,100 for 2025/26. The Advisory Committee notes expenditure of \$11,900 and \$27,900 against the appropriations of \$24,800 and \$36,800 in the 2024/25 and 2023/24 periods, respectively. The Secretary-General indicates that the underexpenditure in 2024/25 is attributable primarily to the non-engagement of individual consultants for intercommunal activities, which were implemented by in-house capacity available in the Force (ibid., para. 58). **The Advisory Committee notes the availability at UNFICYP of in-house capacity to engage in intercommunal activities. Taking into account the pattern of underexpenditure and in support of the efficiency measures of the UN80 Initiative, the Committee recommends resources in the amount of \$24,800, which**

is the approved level for the 2024/25 period, equivalent to a reduction of 20 per cent (\$6,200) to the proposed resources for consultants and consulting services.

Official travel

42. The proposed resources for official travel amount to \$238,500 for 2026/27, representing an increase of \$100, or 0.1 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$238,400 for 2025/26. The Advisory Committee notes expenditure of \$138,900 and \$280,900 against appropriations of \$232,300 and of \$239,900 in the 2024/25 and 2023/24 periods, respectively. The Secretary-General indicates that, in 2024/25, the reduced requirements were attributable primarily to the postponement of travel requirements owing to the reprioritization of resources in the light of the liquidity challenges (*ibid.*, para. 59). Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that the approved resources for official travel for 2025/26 reflected increased requirements attributable to higher airfares for commercial tickets, while the number of planned trips was reduced from 55 to 50. For 2026/27, 55 trips are proposed, which is considered the minimum required to fully implement mandated activities, including participation in professional conferences, meetings and political consultations. The Committee notes that the proposed requirements for 2026/27, with the exception of three trips of the Special Representative of the Secretary-General in Cyprus for consultations with the Security Council or regional meetings and of three trips related to troop-contributing and police-contributing country visits and briefings, pertain primarily to travel for internal professional conferences, meetings and workshops. **The Advisory Committee emphasizes that greater use of virtual meetings, on-the-job training, online platforms and online training tools should be made and reiterates its view that travel for conferences, workshops and professional meetings should be kept to a minimum in order to achieve efficiencies, in particular in the context of the UN80 Initiative. The Committee therefore recommends a reduction of 10 per cent (\$23,900) to the proposed resources for official travel.**

43. The Advisory Committee recalls that, for UNFICYP, there is no separate budget line for within-mission travel, given that it is included under “official travel” (see [A/79/724/Add.2](#), para. 32). Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that, given the mission’s area of operations, movements within the geographical area were not considered official travel in line with the administrative instruction on the system of daily subsistence allowance ([ST/AI/2014/2](#)) and therefore did not trigger daily subsistence allowance payments nor generate additional costs beyond those associated with ground transportation for patrols and other routine movements. Accordingly, the full provision for non-training official travel relates exclusively to travel undertaken outside the mission area. **The Advisory Committee notes that the lack of information on travel within the mission area limits the transparency of the presentation of operational resources and the relationship between mobility requirements and related expenditure, also in the context of vehicle ratios for national staff, as further described in paragraph 46 below. The Committee trusts that future budget submissions will provide further information on travel plans within the mission and the corresponding estimated and actual costs (see also [A/79/724/Add.2](#), para. 32).**

Facilities and infrastructure

44. The proposed resources for facilities and infrastructure amount to \$8,430,700 for 2026/27, representing an increase of \$1,093,800, or 14.9 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$7,336,900 for 2025/26, while expenditure amounted to \$6,829,100 for 2024/25 and \$3,527,800 as at 28 February 2026. The Secretary-General indicates that the increased requirements for 2026/27 are attributable

primarily to the application of a higher euro/dollar exchange rate, increases for catering services contracts, increases for cleaning, grounds maintenance and road-sweeping services contracts, higher prices for the maintenance of seven photovoltaic plants resulting from the revised contract, higher electricity costs sources from the host country's electricity grid, and higher costs of solid waste management services (A/80/607, para. 61). The Advisory Committee notes that, for the 2021/22 and 2022/23 periods, facilities and infrastructure had appropriations of \$6,937,700 and 6,720,900 and expenditure of \$6,069,400 and \$6,620,500, respectively. In the 2023/24 period, with the project for the relocation of the Force's headquarters, the appropriation increased to \$8,286,500, with expenditure in the amount of \$8,352,500. Between 2024/25 and 2025/26, the facilities and infrastructure object of expenditure increased from \$7,319,400 to \$7,336,900, while the proposed budget for 2026/27 amounts to \$8,430,700. **While cognizant of the financial impact of exchange rates on the proposed resources, the Advisory Committee is of the view that additional efforts are required to contain the continuing increase in the proposed resources under facilities and infrastructure and trusts that more information on any efficiency measures and contract negotiations undertaken by the mission in that regard will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report. In view of the expenditure patterns in recent years, the Committee recommends a reduction of 5 per cent (\$421,500) to the proposed resources for facilities and infrastructure.**

Ground transportation

45. The proposed resources for ground transportation amount to \$2,002,000 for 2026/27, representing a decrease of \$94,800, or 4.5 per cent, compared with the approved level of \$2,096,800 for 2025/26. The Advisory Committee notes expenditure of \$1,833,700 and \$1,648,900 against appropriations of \$1,854,300 and of \$1,857,800 in the 2024/25 and 2023/24 periods, respectively. The reduced requirements are attributable primarily to fewer vehicles proposed for replacement in 2026/27 than originally planned. Upon enquiry, the Committee was informed that 26 vehicles would be written off by 30 January 2026 because these were beyond economical repair or were no longer meeting operational, safety or environmental requirements. Owing to liquidity constraints, UNFICYP has made adjustments to its vehicle acquisition plan and has extended the replacement cycle until 2027/28, as follows: (a) for 2025/26, the acquisition of three vehicles was deferred from 2024/25 to 2025/26 owing to liquidity constraints, increasing the number of planned vehicle acquisitions to 21, from the 18 originally planned; (b) for 2026/27, 15 vehicles are scheduled for replacement; and (c) for 2027/28, 9 vehicles would be replaced.

46. With respect to vehicle ratios, the Advisory Committee was informed that the primary reason that UNFICYP had exceeded the standard vehicle ratio for light passenger vehicles was that the current methodology did not take into account the use of vehicles by national General Service staff who, as also indicated in paragraph 35 above, comprise 75 per cent of civilian staff and require vehicles to discharge their responsibilities. The Committee recalls that the General Assembly, in its resolution 79/258, expressed concern about the significant variance between actual vehicle holdings and standard allocations. The Committee also recalls that the Secretariat, when reviewing the vehicle ratios, found that having separate ratios for each category of staff that would be applicable to all entities was not practicable (A/79/724/Add.2, para. 29).

47. **The Advisory Committee recalls that it has repeatedly reiterated its expectation that all efforts will be made by UNFICYP to align the number of vehicles with the standard ratios (see A/79/724/Add.2, para. 30, A/78/744/Add.2, para. 29, and A/77/767/Add.1, para. 25 (a)). The Committee reiterates that the**

Force should adopt a phased and judicious approach to the planned vehicle replacements, with a view to realigning them with the standard ratios, while taking into consideration mission specificities. Furthermore, the Committee trusts that efforts will be made to obtain vehicles and equipment from closed or closing missions, as operationally feasible, so as to obviate the need to acquire new vehicles.

Petrol, oil and lubricants

48. In terms of petrol, oil and lubricants, \$741,900 is proposed for the 2026/27 period, reflecting an increase of \$14,500, or 1.9 per cent, primarily as a result of higher fuel costs under ground transportation (\$463,500, representing an increase of \$12,500, or 2.6 per cent) and air operations (\$170,700, representing an increase of \$21,100, or 14.1 per cent), and of lower fuel costs under facilities and infrastructure (\$107,700, representing a decrease of \$5,700, or 5.7 per cent). **The Advisory Committee trusts that updated information on fuel costs will be provided to the General Assembly at the time of its consideration of the present report.**

49. **Subject to its recommendations in paragraphs 41, 42 and 44 above, the Advisory Committee recommends the approval of the proposals of the Secretary-General for operational costs.**

V. Other matters

Environmental initiatives

50. The Secretary-General indicates that UNFICYP will continue to reduce its environmental footprint through the installation of a ninth photovoltaic power plant and the gradual replacement of obsolete electrical appliances with eco-friendly units (A/80/607, para. 18). Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that a reduction in electricity consumption by 49,276 kWh was recorded when comparing the 2023/24 and 2024/25 periods, resulting in estimated cost savings of \$1,478,562, and that a reduction of water consumption by 11,444 m³ was recorded when comparing the 2023/24 and 2024/25 periods, resulting in estimated cost savings of \$90,273. **The Advisory Committee notes the efforts of UNFICYP to improve its environmental footprint and trusts that further efficiency gains will continue to be generated from the photovoltaic power plants, as well as other environmental initiatives, and will be reflected in future reports.**

Management of sea containers

51. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 31 January 2026, UNFICYP held 185 sea containers: (a) 160 containers used as laundry facilities and archive and material storage; and (b) 25 containers held in stock for temporary storage. No surplus containers were available for return to the logistics operators. The Committee discusses the management of sea containers in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

Equitable geographical representation and gender parity

52. Upon enquiry, the Advisory Committee was informed that, as at 16 February 2026, UNFICYP comprised 131 staff at all levels. Among the international staff, 30 nationalities were represented. Of the 131 staff, 73 (56 per cent) were men and 58 (44 per cent) were women.

53. As at 31 December 2025, international UNFICYP staff were from the following regional groups: African States (5); Asia-Pacific States (8); Eastern European States

(3); Latin American and the Caribbean States (2); Western European and other States (13); as well as the United States of America (5) and others (1).

54. **The Advisory Committee trusts that UNFICYP will further increase its efforts to promote equitable geographical representation and gender parity.** The Advisory Committee discusses equitable geographical representation and gender parity in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

VI. Conclusion

55. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNFICYP for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/607). **The Advisory Committee notes the unencumbered balance of \$1,167,100 for the period from 1 July 2024 to 30 June 2025, as well as other revenue amounting to \$1,429,000 in investment revenue (\$619,600), other/miscellaneous revenue (\$575,400) and the cancellation of prior-period obligations (\$234,000) for the period ended 30 June 2025. The Committee also notes the proposal of the Secretary-General to place the credits arising from the above-mentioned revenue and adjustments into a reserve that would be used in the event that collections are insufficient to enable the full, efficient and effective implementation of mandates. The Committee considers that this is a policy matter to be decided by the General Assembly.** The Advisory Committee makes further comments in its report on cross-cutting issues related to peacekeeping operations (A/80/604).

56. The actions to be taken by the General Assembly with regard to the financing of UNFICYP for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 are indicated in section IV of the report of the Secretary-General (A/80/607). **Taking into account its observations and recommendations above, the Advisory Committee recommends that the proposed resources be reduced by \$451,600, from \$56,279,700 to \$55,828,100. Accordingly, the Committee recommends that the General Assembly appropriate the amount of \$55,828,100 for the maintenance of the Force for the 12-month period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027.** A summary of the budgetary impact and the financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee with regard to the financing of UNFICYP for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027 is presented in the table below.

Budgetary impact and financial implications resulting from the recommendations of the Advisory Committee for the United Nations Peacekeeping Force in Cyprus for the period from 1 July 2026 to 30 June 2027

<i>Category</i>	<i>Paragraph number (present report)</i>	<i>Recommendation of the Advisory Committee</i>	<i>Financial implication (United States dollars)</i>
Operational costs			
Consultants and consulting services	41	Reduction of 20 per cent	6 200
Official travel	42	Reduction of 10 per cent	23 900
Facilities and infrastructure	44	Reduction of 5 per cent	421 500
Total			451 600